

Steve Jobs had multiple demo units on stage during its unveiling and had to switch between demo units the moment one of them stopped responding. Moving on from the unveiling, a couple of months down the line, Apple announced the iPhone OS SDK which could be used to develop apps for the OS. At the time of its launch, Apple had no plans of opening up the App Store to third party developers and the only way devs could get a piece of the action was to develop web-apps which could work just as well as the native apps. Something we all know not to be true. Native apps are simply capable of making much better use of the iPhone's resources, a fact that stands true even to this day. Some companies have even gone ahead and



sued Apple to improve HTML5 performance in iOS to help make HTML5 apps perform better on iOS, but that's another story for some other time.

iOS got another major device category with the launch of the iPod Touch which was essentially an iPhone without the phone calling functionality. The iPod Touch might not be popular any more since there are much cheaper Android devices which do a much better job and the fact that the iPhone is practically a superset of the iPod's features.

Since then, iOS has come a long way and has hit many milestones with the App Store as well. It is estimated that by the year 2020, the App Store will host five million apps. The current set of apps on the App Store have been downloaded over 130 billion times. So the app store is doing pretty well and is a major source of revenue for Apple, bringing in over 28 billion dollars in 2016 – a figure that grew by 40 per cent year-on-year.

iOS Milestones

As mentioned previously, the OS for the iPhone and iPod started out as the